

FIRST READING Isaiah 44:6-8

A reading from ISAIAH:

⁶ Thus says the LORD, the King of Israel,
and his Redeemer, the LORD of hosts:

I am the first, and I am the last;
besides me there is no god.

⁷ Who is like me? Let them proclaim it;
let them declare and set it forth before
me.

Who has announced from of old the
things to come?

Let them tell us what is yet to be.

⁸ Do not fear or be afraid;
have I not told you from of old and
declared it?
You are my witnesses!
Is there any god besides me?
There is no other rock; I know not one.

The Word of the Lord.

Thanks be to God.

PSALM 86:11-17

Please read with me responsively PSALM
86:11-17

¹¹ Teach me your way, O Lord, and I will
walk in your truth;
give me an undivided heart to revere your
name.

¹² **I will thank you, O Lord my God,
with all my heart,
and glorify your name forevermore.**

¹³ For great is your love toward me;
you have delivered me from the pit of
death.

¹⁴ **The arrogant rise up against me, O
God, and a band of violent people seeks
my life;
they have not set you before their eyes.**

¹⁵ But you, O Lord, are gracious and full
of compassion,
slow to anger, and full of kindness and
truth.

¹⁶ **Turn to me and have mercy on me;
give your strength to your servant, and
save the child of your handmaid.**

¹⁷ Show me a sign of your favor, so that
those who hate me may see it and be put
to shame;
because you, Lord, have helped me and
comforted me.

SECOND READING: Romans 8:12-25

A reading from ROMANS

¹² So then, brothers and sisters, we are
obligated, not to the flesh, to live
according to the flesh—¹³ for if you live
according to the flesh, you will die, but if
by the Spirit you put to death the deeds of
the body, you will live. ¹⁴ For all who are
led by the Spirit of God are children of
God. ¹⁵ For you did not receive a spirit of
slavery to fall back into fear, but you

received a spirit of adoption. When we cry, “Abba! Father!” ¹⁶ it is that very Spirit bearing witness with our spirit that we are children of God, ¹⁷ and if children, then heirs: heirs of God and joint heirs with Christ, if we in fact suffer with him so that we may also be glorified with him.

¹⁸ I consider that the sufferings of this present time are not worth comparing with the glory about to be revealed to us.

¹⁹ For the creation waits with eager longing for the revealing of the children of God, ²⁰ for the creation was subjected to futility, not of its own will, but by the will of the one who subjected it, in hope

²¹ that the creation itself will be set free from its enslavement to decay and will obtain the freedom of the glory of the

children of God. ²² We know that the whole creation has been groaning together as it suffers together the pains of labor, ²³ and not only the creation, but we ourselves, who have the first fruits of the Spirit, groan inwardly while we wait for adoption, the redemption of our bodies. ²⁴ For in hope we were saved. Now hope that is seen is not hope, for who hopes for what one already sees? ²⁵ But if we hope for what we do not see, we wait for it with patience.

The word of the Lord.

Thanks be to God.

Please rise in *BODY* or *SPIRIT* for the reading of the Gospel.

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